

Ross Dahlke

Assistant Professor

ross.dahlke@wisc.edu

rossdahlke.com

@rossdahlke

University of Wisconsin–Madison, SJMC

Academic Appointments

University of Wisconsin–Madison

Assistant Professor

Madison, WI

2025–Present

- School of Journalism and Mass Communication
- Affiliate, Elections Research Center (2025–Present)
- Affiliate, Data Science Institute (2026–Present)

Education

Stanford University

PhD, Communication

Palo Alto, CA

2022–2024

- Dissertation: *The Public Sphere in Private Spaces: Politics, News, and Misinformation in Personal Messaging Applications*
- Advisor: Jeffrey T. Hancock. Committee: Jennifer Pan, Byron Reeves, Matthew Gentzkow, Michael Bernstein (chair)
- Data Science Scholar, Stanford Data Science Program
- Knight–Hennessy Scholar

Stanford University

MA, Communication

Palo Alto, CA

2020–2022

- Knight–Hennessy Scholar

University of Wisconsin–Madison

JBA, Comprehensive Honors

Madison, WI

2014–2018

Journalism & Mass Communication · Political Science

- Theodore Herfurth Award for top undergraduate male student
- College of Letters & Science Dean's Prize (awarded to three students)

Research

Publications

** indicates equal authorship*

15. Dahlke, R., Yang, Y., Lukito, J., Greenfield, J., Chen, B., Brown, M. A., & Lewis, R. (2026). Style and substance on The Alex Jones Show predict InfoWars sales: a multi-modal analysis of a media empire. *Information, Communication & Society*, 1–20. <https://doi.org/10.1080/1369118X.2026.2642851>
14. Dahlke*, R., Moore*, R. C., Bengani, P., & Hancock, J. T. (2026). The Consumption of Pink Slime Journalism: Who, What, When, Where, and Why? *Digital Journalism*, 1–23. <https://doi.org/10.1080/21670811.2026.2669525>

Award · Top Student Paper Award, Political Communication Division of the International Communication Association 2024 Conference

Coverage · Northwestern Local News Initiative, The Boston Globe

13. **Dahlke**, R., Mine, N., Zhao, H., Huang, Y., & Shah, D. (2026). Electoral Predictions on Polymarket: A Quantitative Description of Trading, Commenting, and Reacting. *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*, 6. <https://doi.org/10.51685/jqd.2026.011>
12. Kim, Y. M., **Dahlke**, R., Song, H., & Heinrich, R. (2026). Targeted digital voter suppression efforts likely decrease voter turnout. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 123(5), e2519944123. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2519944123>
11. Lee, A. Y., Stevic, A., Walker-Keleher, G., Chen, C., Charity, E., **Dahlke**, R., & Hancock, J. (2026). Going light: The effects of minimal mobile phone adoption on young adults' well-being depend on motivation. *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772318.3791723>
Coverage · The New York Times
10. **Dahlke***, R., Tu*, F., Wang*, Y.-C., Lu, Y., Engeda, B. W., & Hancock, J. T. (2025). Contextualizing Misinformation: A User-Centric Approach to Linguistic and Topical Patterns in News Consumption. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction*, 9(CSCW1), 1–40. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3757571>
9. **Dahlke**, R., & Hancock, J. (2025). Untrustworthy website exposure and election beliefs: Selective exposure and ideological asymmetry. *Journal of Online Trust and Safety*, 3(1). <https://doi.org/10.54501/jots.v3i1.250>
8. **Dahlke**, R., Kumar, D., Durumeric, Z., & Hancock, J. T. (2025). Quantifying the Systematic Bias in the Accessibility and Inaccessibility of Web Scraping Content From URL-Logged Web-Browsing Digital Trace Data. *Social Science Computer Review*, 43(5), 1071–1086. <https://doi.org/10.1177/08944393231218214>
7. Lukito, J., Macdonald, M., Chen, B., Brown, M. A., Prochaska, S., Yang, Y., Greenfield, J., Suk, J., Zhong, W., **Dahlke**, R., & Borah, P. (2025). Candidates Be Posting: Multi-Platform Strategies and Partisan Preferences in the 2022 US Midterm Elections. *Social Media+ Society*, 11(2), 20563051251337541. <https://doi.org/10.1177/20563051251337541>
6. **Dahlke**, R., & Pan, J. (2024). January 6 Arrests and Media Coverage Do Not Remobilize Conservatives on Social Media. *Proceedings of the National Academies of Sciences*. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2401239121>
5. Moore*, R. C., **Dahlke***, R., Forberg, P. L., & Hancock, J. T. (2024). The Private Life of QAnon: A Mixed Methods Investigation of Americans' Exposure to QAnon Content on the Web. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction*, 8(CSCW2), 1–34. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3687057>
4. **Dahlke**, R., & Zhang, Y. (2024). Surviving or thriving political defeat on social media: a temporal analysis of how electoral loss exacerbates the gender gap in political expression. *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication*, 29(1), zmad051. <https://doi.org/10.1093/jcmc/zmad051>
3. Chen, B., Borah, P., **Dahlke**, R., & Lukito, J. (2024). Battle for Inbox and Bucks: Comparing Email Fundraising Strategies of Donald Trump and Joe Biden in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election. *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*. <https://doi.org/10.51685/jqd.2024.012>
2. Lukito, J., Greenfield, J., Yang, Y., **Dahlke**, R., Brown, M. A., Lewis, R., & Chen, B. (2024). Audio-as-data tools: Replicating computational data processing. *Media and Communication*, 12. <https://doi.org/10.17645/mac.7851>
1. Moore*, R. C., **Dahlke***, R., & Hancock, J. T. (2023). Exposure to untrustworthy websites in the 2020 US election. *Nature Human Behaviour*, 1096–1105. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-023-01564-2>
Coverage · The New York Times, World Economic Forum, Minnesota Star Tribune, The Daily Beast

Papers Under Review

* indicates equal authorship

6. **Dahlke, R.**, Moore, R., Adib-Azpeitia, D., Ugander, J., & Hancock, J. (2026). Multi-Platform Referrers of Misinformation: A Comparative Ablation Study of Misinformation Visits Referred by Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, Reddit, YouTube, Snapchat, and TikTok. Forthcoming at *Political Communication*.
5. **Dahlke***, R., Moore*, R. C., & Hancock, J. T. (2026). Exposure to (AI-generated) untrustworthy websites in the 2024 US election. Revise & Resubmit at *Nature Communications*. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/qtdmg_v1
4. Lukito, J., Zhang, Y., Pruden, M., Prochaska, S., Chen, B., Zhong, W., Brown, M., **Dahlke, R.**, Suk, J., Greenfield, J., & Borah, P. (2026). Cross-Platformization: How U.S. Right-Leaning Media Curate Their Posts on Twitter and Truth Social. Revise & Resubmit at *New Media and Society*.
3. Kwon, H., Jiang, X., & **Dahlke, R.** (2026). Do Politicians' Strategic Facial Expressions Drive Resonant Moments on Social Media? Computational Analysis of the 2024 U.S. Presidential Debate Using Multi-modal Large Language Models. Revise & Resubmit at *International Journal of Communication*.
2. **Dahlke, R.**, Lee, A. Y., Stevic, A., Walker-Keleher, G., Chen, C. Q.-A., Charity, E., & Hancock, J. T. (2026). Replacing Smartphones With Minimal Mobile Phones Improves College Students' Trust in News but Not News-Finds-Me Perceptions. Under Review.
1. **Dahlke, R.**, & Hancock, J. (2025). The Public Sphere in Private Spaces: Quantifying Political Computer-Mediated Communication in Personal Messaging. Under Review. <https://osf.io/6cpv8/>

Public Pre-Prints & Reports

1. Lukito, J., Brown, M. A., **Dahlke, R.**, Suk, J., Yang, Y., Zhang, Y., Chen, B., Kim, S. J., & Soorholtz, K. (2023). The state of digital media data research, 2023. *Social Science Research Council*. <http://dx.doi.org/10.26153/tsw/46177>

Invited Talks & Guest Lectures

The Public Sphere in Private Spaces: Political Content and Sources in Personal Messaging March 2026

Communication and Media Colloquium · University of Iowa

Exploring Ethical Use of AI and Computational Methods in Organizational Research October 2025

Organizational Communication Mini Conference 2025 · University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign

Understanding Election Manipulation with Data Science November 2024

Stanford Democracy Day & Stanford Data Science · Stanford University

Exposure to Untrustworthy Websites in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election November 2023

Communication 124/224: Truth, Trust & Technology · Stanford University

Untrustworthy Website Exposure and Effects November 2023

Stanford Democracy Day & Stanford Data Science · Stanford University

Single Case Research Methodology and Visualization September 2023

University of Minnesota–Twin Cities

Exposure to Untrustworthy Websites in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election

April 2023

Social Technologies Research Group · Cornell Tech

Exposure to Untrustworthy Websites in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election

May 2022

Cyber Policy Center, Freeman Spogli Institute · Stanford University

Awards & Funding

Collaborative Summer Research Initiative (50% Graduate Project Assistantship)

2025

\$10,700

University of Wisconsin–Madison Elections Research Center

Top Reviewer Award, 2023

2024

Social Science Computer Review

Non-Western Countries Expanding Online Trust & Safety Research Grant

2024

\$15,000

Stanford Cyber Policy Center

Data Science Scholar

2023

~\$93,000

Stanford University Data Science

Stanford EST (Ethics, Society, and Technology) Research Grant

2023

\$5,000

Stanford University

Stanford PACS (Philanthropy and Civil Society) Research Grant

2023

\$3,000

Stanford University

Graduate Student Researcher

2023

Office of Army Research & DoD Multidisciplinary University Research Initiative (MURI): Multi-Modal Network Information Dynamics Group

Knight–Hennessy Scholarship

2020

~\$280,000

Stanford University

Teaching

Courses

JOURN 677 – Concepts and Tools for Data Analysis and Visualization

Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026

University of Wisconsin–Madison · Instructor

JOURN 818 – Computational Approaches for Communication Research

Fall 2025

University of Wisconsin–Madison · Instructor

Communication 124/224 – Truth, Trust & Technology *Spring 2024*
Stanford University · Teaching Assistant

Communication 172/272 – Media Psychology *Winter 2023*
Stanford University · Teaching Assistant

Inter-LS 250 – Undergraduate Research Experience *2016–2018*
University of Wisconsin–Madison · Teaching Fellow

Advising
PhD Advising

Haotian (Barry) Zhao
PhD, Journalism & Mass Communication · Advisor

Yanshu (Sybil) Wang
PhD, Journalism & Mass Communication · Advisor

Laila Abbas
PhD, Journalism & Mass Communication · Advisor

Research MA Advising

Yingqi (Vicky) Huang
MA, Journalism & Mass Communication · Advisor

Directed Study

Yanshu (Sybil) Wang *Spring 2026*
Directed Study

Yanshu (Sybil) Wang *Fall 2025*
Directed Study

Professional Development

Madison Teaching and Learning Excellence *August 2025–May 2026*
Center for Teaching, Learning, and Mentoring · University of Wisconsin–Madison

The Discussion Project *August 2025*
Wisconsin Center for Education Research · University of Wisconsin–Madison

Wisconsin Idea Seminar *May 2025*
Office of the Provost · University of Wisconsin–Madison

Service

School of Journalism and Mass Communication

Graduate Committee

January 2025–Present

Member

Disciplinary Service

International Journal of Press + Politics

January 2025–Present

Data Editor

Media & Democracy Data Cooperative (MDDC)

September 2020–Present

Research Lead, Executive Board Member · <https://mddatacoop.org/>

International Communication Association Hackathon

June 2023–June 2024

Co-Organizer · <https://www.hackingcommsci.org/>

Digital Data Conference (D2C)

December 2021–April 2022

Co-Organizer · <https://mediaengagement.org/event/digital-data-conference/>

Peer Reviewer

- AI and Ethics
- Communication Methods and Measures
- Computational Communication Research
- HKS Misinformation Review
- Human Communication Research
- Information Processing and Management
- International Journal of Communication
- International Journal of Public Opinion Research
- Journal of Online Trust and Safety
- Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media
- Journal of Right-Wing Studies
- Mass Communication & Society
- New Media & Society
- Political Communication
- Science Advances
- Social Science Computer Review
- Virtual Reality

Professional Experience

Ovative Group

Minneapolis, MN

Data Scientist

2018–2020